

Backup and Retention Standard (v1)

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Purpose

This standard defines how often Meridian Instruments systems are backed up, how long backups are retained, where copies are stored and how restores are tested. It covers on-premises systems in the Leeds data centre, site servers in Rotterdam, Austin and Penang, and the TesseraCloud production environment.

Backup platform

Backups are taken with the Strata Backup platform. The primary backup repository is in the Leeds data centre (repository name STRATA-LDS-01). An offsite copy is written to the Rotterdam site vault.

Backup frequency and retention

Backup type | Frequency | Retention

Daily incremental | Every night, 23:00 local time | 35 days
Weekly full | Sunday 02:00 | 8 weeks
Monthly full | First Sunday of the month | 12 months
Yearly full (Atlas finance data) | 1 April (start of fiscal year) | 7 years
TesseraCloud telemetry database snapshot | Every 6 hours | 14 days

Offsite copies

A copy of the most recent weekly full backup is replicated to the Rotterdam vault every week (Monday 06:00). Offsite copies are retained for the same period as the source backup.

System-specific rules

- Atlas production database (atlas-db-prd-01): archive logs backed up every 30 minutes, retained 35 days.
- Keel HR portal: data is held by the HR platform vendor; Meridian keeps a monthly export for 12 months.
- Forge (CI/CD): repositories backed up nightly; build artefacts are not backed up.
- File shares: nightly incremental, 35 days.

Restore testing

A full restore test of Atlas and one file share is performed once per year and recorded in Beacon (category SEC-BACKUP-TEST). Failed restore tests are treated as SEV3 incidents.

Encryption

All backups are encrypted at rest using AES-256. Encryption keys are held by IT Infrastructure and escrowed with IT Security.

Review

This standard is reviewed every two years.